

Consider the interrelationship between media technologies and patterns of consumption and response:

- The game is linked to a more traditional **console** version and which was simultaneously released with this game. This might be considered as an attempt to draw gamers from different **platforms** to purchase additional hardware and adopt new gaming habits.
- The two versions of the game are also linked in terms of **downloadable content and special features**. This relates to changing patterns of **consumption**. Gamers might be being encouraged to have a more complete or satisfying experience by using a range of interlinked products that offer exclusive downloadable content. This is only made possible through **convergent technology** and gamer “buy-in” to the value of the exclusive content.

Consider theoretical perspectives:

Media effects – Albert Bandura

- The game received an **18 rating from PEGI** due largely to violent content.
- Consider audience response to violent video games in terms of Bandura’s arguments about observation and **imitation** and vicarious consequences. Explore the “Bobo Doll Experiment” and discuss how relevant this is to the audiences targeted by the game. Are audiences likely to imitate the behaviours

portrayed in the game? What might be imitated?

- A useful discussion might be had in relation to the **active role** adopted by a player of video games. Question whether Bandura’s conclusions are invalidated or made more relevant if audiences are choosing to commit acts of violence in a video game rather than watching/imitating violent acts.

A level only:

Fandom – Henry Jenkins

- Discuss the significance of **fan culture** (and in particular **online fan communities**) when exploring the success of video games. This discussion may focus on the way video games have evolved closely alongside the **internet**. Video games offer **social experiences** (online multiplayer options) as well as communities outside of the core game experience. Fans may be passionate exponents of a game or the harshest critics and can often impact the **development** of games directly.
- The *Assassin’s Creed* **franchise** has a strong, well developed **fan-base** that could be researched and discussed in relation to Jenkins’ ideas.